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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Musk broadcast** an all-hands meeting with Tesla employees and urged them not to sell their shares of the electric carmaker amid investors' wariness of his role in the Trump administration. **B9**
- ◆ **Some of Tesla's** most avid investors are now selling shares, which have fallen about 38% this year. **B9**
- ◆ **The Hoffmann Family** of Cos. is looking to buy Lee Enterprises after increasing its stake in the media company over six months. **B9**
- ◆ **Chinese food-delivery giant** Meituan reported a near tripling of fourth-quarter profit as revenue jumped. **B10**
- ◆ **Johnson & Johnson** said it was increasing U.S. investments to more than \$55 billion over the next four years. **B10**
- ◆ **The Federal Reserve** ran an operating loss of \$77.6 billion last year, the second straight year of large losses. **A2**
- ◆ **Gold prices** posted their third consecutive week of gains, firming above \$3,000 a troy ounce. **B11**
- ◆ **U.S. stocks** rose for the week with the Dow, S&P 500 and Nasdaq gaining 1.2%, 0.5% and 0.2%, respectively. **B11**
- ◆ **NIO's fourth-quarter** net loss unexpectedly widened as higher costs outpaced sales growth. **B10**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Boeing has been selected** to build what may turn out to be the most expensive fighter in history, a sophisticated jet the Air Force believes is vital to deter China in the decades ahead. **A1**
- ◆ **Columbia University** will cede to Trump's demands in negotiations over \$400 million in federal funding he revoked this month. **A1**
- ◆ **A federal judge** said he was troubled by the Trump administration's use of war-time powers to remove alleged Venezuelan gang members from the U.S. **A4**
- ◆ **Trump said Musk** wouldn't receive a sensitive briefing at the Pentagon on a plan for potential war with China because of his financial ties to Beijing. **A5**
- ◆ **Germany's mammoth** spending package cleared its last parliamentary hurdle, paving the way for as much as €1 trillion in civilian and defense investments. **A7**
- ◆ **Israel's defense minister** threatened permanent occupation of parts of the Gaza Strip and the displacement of its population if Hamas doesn't free all hostages. **A8**
- ◆ **Sudan's military** seized back control of the last remaining bastion of the rival paramilitary group in the capital. **A9**
- ◆ **Died:** George Foreman, 76, heavyweight boxing champion and businessman. **A5**

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The courtroom and the splashdown **A13**

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Fire Shuts Down Heathrow Airport, Snarls Travel



FIRE FIGHT: A blaze at an electrical substation triggered a power outage at London's Heathrow, upending journeys for hundreds of thousands of passengers. Flights were resuming late Friday. For video, scan the code with the article on **A8**.

Columbia Capitulates to Trump In Fight Over Federal Funding

By Douglas Belkin

Columbia University will cede to President Trump's far-reaching demands in negotiations over \$400 million in federal funding he revoked this month, according to a memo from the school to the administration.

Columbia agreed to ban masks, empower 36 campus police officers with new pow-

ers to arrest students and appoint a senior vice provost with broad authority to oversee the department of Middle East, South Asian and African Studies as well as the Center for Palestine Studies.

Control of the Middle East department has been a central dispute in negotiations and sparks controversy across campus. Faculty at Columbia and nationwide are expressing

deep reservations about letting the federal government dictate how they can operate an academic department. The new vice provost, appointed by Columbia, will review curriculum, nontenure faculty hiring and leadership "to ensure the educational offerings are comprehensive and balanced."

Columbia's acquiescence is a significant moment in the

intensifying battle between Trump and elite universities. Trump campaigned on curbing what he sees as leftist ideology in higher education, and has moved aggressively to investigate allegations of campus antisemitism, with Columbia as his main focus.

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◆ **President ramps up his bid to settle scores.....** **A4**

Ukrainians Recount Perilous Russia Retreat

By Isabel Coles and Ievgenia Sivorka

SUMY, Ukraine—As the pocket of territory held by Ukrainian troops in Russia shrank around him, Ukrainian Sr. Sgt. Zenon Dashak began plotting a way out.

For weeks, few supply vehicles could get through to the troops in Kursk province as Russian advances had brought the roads into the range of explosive-drone teams—leaving Ukrainian stocks so low that some soldiers melted snow for drinking water.

Dashak, a drone operator, began studying maps. With roads under fire, he and his men would face a perilous hike through forests and swamps.

It was a harsh end to a seven-month operation that shocked Moscow and the West with the first invasion of Russian territory since World War II. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky would later declare that the operation had achieved its aims by catching Russia off guard, drawing in Russian forces that could have been deployed in Ukraine and seizing hundreds of prisoners.

Critics have questioned whether it was worth the troops and equipment ex-

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A Warship Shows Why China Is Challenging the U.S. Navy

Blizzard of design changes by military have put production of Constellation years behind schedule and millions over budget

By Alistair MacDonald and Gordon Lubold

When a Wisconsin shipyard won the contract to build a new class of Navy frigate in 2020, the project was meant to address an embarrassing reality: The U.S. is now the global laggard in building warships.

Stocked with high-tech weaponry to protect against enemy submarines, missiles and drones, the USS Constellation was expected to be ready for the open water in 2026. That was because the U.S. chose a proven design from Italian shipbuilder Fincantieri in an effort to speed the process.

Then the Navy started tinkering. The hull was lengthened by 24 feet to accommodate larger generators and reconfigured

in part because the design was based on the relatively benign conditions in the Mediterranean, and the propeller changed for better acoustic performance, among other time-consuming adjustments.

The effect: Like almost all other U.S. naval vessels, the Constellation is already years behind schedule and millions over budget.

Physical construction began in mid-2022, and after more than 2½ years, the project is only 10% complete, according to a person familiar with the timeline.

At this pace, including the two years of design time before building began, the ship will be completed in a total of nine years—around twice as long as it took an Italian shipyard to

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Boeing Gets Nod On Jet Fighter

Pick follows years of company problems, from crashes to quality crisis

By Michael R. Gordon and Sharon Terlep

WASHINGTON—Boeing won the contract to build what may turn out to be the most expensive jet fighter in history, a sophisticated air-to-air interceptor the Air Force believes is vital to deter China's military in the decades ahead.

The Pentagon's selection of Boeing to deliver its next-generation jet fighter has big implications for the aerospace giant's bottom line, its beleaguered defense unit and the jet maker's strained relationship with the Trump administration. The cost-plus contract marks Boeing's biggest win after years of problems that include a pair of fatal crashes, billions in losses and a quality crisis in the wake of last year's fuselage-panel blowout on an Alaska Airlines flight.

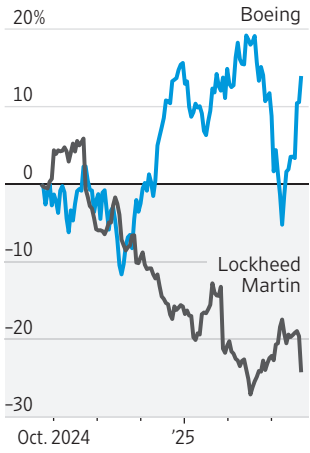
Boeing shares rose 3.1% following the decision, announced by President Trump at the White House on Friday. Shares in rival Lockheed Martin, which had been vying for the project, fell nearly 6%.

Dubbed the F-47, the piloted jet with new stealth and long-range strike capabilities is designed to fight with semi-autonomous drones already well into development. The Air Force expects the first jets to be in service before the end of the Trump administration, said Gen. David Allvin, the Air Force chief of staff, who attended the White House meeting. Experimental prototypes have been flying for five years.

The Pentagon hasn't released cost estimates. Experts say the total research, development and acquisition costs

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Stock performance, past six months



Source: FactSet

◆ **Musk's Pentagon visit not on China, Trump says.....** **A5**

Paper Straw Crusaders' Lonely Fight

Trump order fuels return to plastic; 'complete panic'

By Joseph Pisani

Plastic straws are making a comeback. Karrie Laughton has two words for them: Suck it.

The co-owner of paper-straw company Roc Paper Straws put the phrase on a sipper she designed last

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EXCHANGE



GRIM TALE
Disney's live-action remake of Snow White is making everyone grumpy. **B1**

Who Paid How Much For the Boston Celtics?

By Robert O'Connell and Miriam Gottfried

By the time they're ready to spend their billions, most sports owners are already celebrities in their own right: Wall Street titans, CEOs of prominent companies, heirs of America's richest families.

But when the most prestigious team in the NBA was sold for \$6.1 billion—a record price for a pro sports franchise—the most shocking part of the deal wasn't how much the buyer paid. It was the person who bought it.

William Chisholm, the little-known managing partner of a little-known private-equity firm, will become the new owner of the Boston Celtics after agreeing to purchase the team from Wyc Grousbeck, the parties announced on Thursday.

The deal stunned NBA insiders and private-equity investors—and even Chisholm himself.

"You think of me at 8 years old, 10 years old, watching the Celtics and never dreaming that this could possibly happen

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